PRACTICE EXAM 3 OF 3 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL SECTIONS

Practice exam 3 of 3

25 questions across all six sections, in mixed order, with 5 choose-two items.

QUESTIONS 25 FORMAT Timed MODULE 40 of 40

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Treat this as the real thing

- Each question stays on screen for **nine seconds** after it is read. Answer in that time.
- Write down your letter, or two letters for **choose-two** items, before the walkthrough.
- Each answer slide names the **section**. Note which section every miss belongs to.
- Do not pause to think longer. The time pressure is part of the practice.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Which section your misses cluster in matters more than your score. The scoring slide at the end shows what to do with it.

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> A home insurer wants an assistant that reads a claimant's photos of storm damage alongside their written claim.
>
> It must describe the damage and flag mismatches with the written account.

Which model attribute is essential?

A The longest available text-only context window

B The largest number of embedding dimensions

C The lowest price per million output tokens

D Support for image inputs as well as text

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which model attribute is essential?

A The longest available text-only context window
A text-only model cannot see the photos.

B The largest number of embedding dimensions
Vectors, not descriptions of damage.

C The lowest price per million output tokens
Cheap is irrelevant if it cannot see images.

D Support for image inputs as well as text
It must see the photos to describe them.

THE SIGNAL

Describe what photos show. The input is an image, so image input is a hard requirement.

> A policy index on a standard endpoint uses continuous sync. Its source table is refreshed once a night by a batch job.
>
> The team has been asked to cut AI Search costs without making answers less fresh.

What should the engineer change?

A. Keep continuous sync, but sync fewer columns into the index

B. Switch to triggered sync, started after each nightly load

C. Move to a storage-optimised endpoint, keeping continuous sync

D. Replace it with a Direct Vector Access index written by hand

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the engineer change?

A Keep continuous sync, but sync fewer columns into the index

The always-on pipeline is the cost, not the columns.

B Switch to triggered sync, started after each nightly load

Same freshness for nightly data, no always-on pipeline.

C Move to a storage-optimised endpoint, keeping continuous sync

Impossible: storage-optimised is triggered only.

D Replace it with a Direct Vector Access index written by hand

Swaps automatic sync for hand-written code.

THE SIGNAL

Refreshed nightly, synced continuously. Paying for seconds of freshness the data never needs.

> An engineering manager wants to know which service principals consumed the most tokens on a shared endpoint last week.
>
> The endpoint runs behind Unity AI Gateway with usage tracking and payload logging enabled.

Where should the manager look?

A The usage tracking system table, grouped by requester

B The inference table payloads, counting words per request

C The MLflow judge scores on the week's production traces

D The budget alerts configured for model serving spend

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Where should the manager look?

A The usage tracking system table, grouped by requester

Token counts by requester are exactly what it records.

B The inference table payloads, counting words per request

Words are not tokens, and reads sensitive text needlessly.

C The MLflow judge scores on the week's production traces

Quality, not consumption.

D The budget alerts configured for model serving spend

Spend thresholds, not who consumed what.

THE SIGNAL

Who consumed how many tokens. That is the meter: usage tracking.

> Engineers search a parts catalogue by exact part codes such as PX-4471, as well as by descriptions.
>
> Vector search finds good matches for descriptions, but often misses exact part codes.

What should the team change?

A Increase the number of embedding dimensions

B Increase the chunk size so codes gain context

C Use hybrid search, adding keyword matching

D Enable the reranker on every single query

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team change?

A Increase the number of embedding dimensions
Embeddings still blur exact codes.

B Increase the chunk size so codes gain context
Bigger chunks blur codes further.

C Use hybrid search, adding keyword matching
Keyword matching catches exact codes.

D Enable the reranker on every single query
Cannot rerank a code that was never retrieved.

THE SIGNAL

Meaning works, exact codes fail. Exact tokens need keyword matching alongside the vectors.

> An agent reads inbound customer emails, can look up any customer's account records, and can call an outbound webhook to a partner system.
>
> Security wants the single change that most reduces the risk of data being exfiltrated through injected instructions.

What should the team do?

A Add a line to the prompt telling it to ignore suspicious emails

B Upgrade to a larger model that is fooled less often by injection

C Log every request so that any exfiltration can be investigated

D Require human approval before the agent calls the outbound webhook

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do?

A Add a line to the prompt telling it to ignore suspicious emails

Can itself be argued around.

B Upgrade to a larger model that is fooled less often by injection

Fooled less often is still fooled.

C Log every request so that any exfiltration can be investigated

Records the theft after it happens.

D Require human approval before the agent calls the outbound webhook

Gates the outbound leg of the trifecta.

THE SIGNAL

Untrusted email, private records, and a way out. Break one leg: gate the outbound action.

> An EU bank has opted out of provider data retention, and its residency policy forbids processing outside the region. It is reviewing a candidate model's terms.
>
> Choose TWO.

Which two facts would disqualify the model?

A It retains prompts for 30 days for safety review

B Its context window is larger than the bank needs

C It runs on a global endpoint needing cross-geo routing

D It scores two points lower on a public benchmark

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two facts would disqualify the model?

A It retains prompts for 30 days for safety review
Breaks the no-retention policy.

B Its context window is larger than the bank needs
More than needed is not a disqualifier.

C It runs on a global endpoint needing cross-geo routing
Breaks the residency policy.

D It scores two points lower on a public benchmark
A small benchmark gap disqualifies nothing.

THE SIGNAL

Retention and residency are hard constraints. Each removes the model from the shortlist on its own.

> A procurement team must pull payment terms, notice period and renewal date from 60,000 supplier contracts into a table, and add new contracts weekly.
>
> They want to design and check the fields on a handful of samples first.

Which approach fits?

A Information Extraction to design the schema, then ai_extract at scale

B A Knowledge Assistant, so staff can ask each contract questions

C A Supervisor Agent with one subagent assigned per extracted field

D ai_summarize over each contract, storing the summaries in a table

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which approach fits?

A Information Extraction to design the schema, then ai_extract at scale

Design on samples, then run the same engine in SQL.

B A Knowledge Assistant, so staff can ask each contract questions

Answers questions; does not fill a table.

C A Supervisor Agent with one subagent assigned per extracted field

Coordination machinery with nothing to coordinate.

D ai_summarize over each contract, storing the summaries in a table

Prose, not the three fields the table needs.

THE SIGNAL

Same fields from every document, into a table, designed on samples. The UI-then-SQL extraction pattern.

> An index was created with embedding_vector_column and embedding_dimension, because the team computes its own vectors with a model hosted elsewhere.
>
> Calling similarity_search with query_text fails.

What should the engineer do?

A Switch the query type to HYBRID so text is accepted

B Move the index over to a storage-optimised endpoint

C Embed the query with the same model and pass query_vector

D Add the model's name to the columns list in the query

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the engineer do?

A Switch the query type to HYBRID so text is accepted

Hybrid still needs a vector Databricks cannot make.

B Move the index over to a storage-optimised endpoint

Endpoint type does not change who owns the embeddings.

C Embed the query with the same model and pass query_vector

Self-managed means you embed queries too.

D Add the model's name to the columns list in the query

columns only chooses returned fields.

THE SIGNAL

embedding_vector_column means self-managed. Databricks has no model to embed your text.

> An assistant produces about 40,000 traces a week. Two policy experts can give three hours a week to labelling.
>
> The team must decide which traces go into the labelling session.

Which traces should the experts see?

A. A random sample of traces taken from across the week

B. Borderline cases, edge cases and judge disagreements

C. The traces that scored highest with the automated judges

D. All traces from the single most active user's sessions

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

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Which traces should the experts see?

A. A random sample of traces taken from across the week
Mostly easy cases the judges already handle.

B. Borderline cases, edge cases and judge disagreements
Where human judgement adds the most.

C. The traces that scored highest with the automated judges
The cases least likely to teach anything.

D. All traces from the single most active user's sessions
Narrow and unrepresentative.

THE SIGNAL

Scarce expert time goes where judgement is needed: borderline, uncovered, and disputed cases.

A team has 3,000 labelled examples and an F1 metric for a document-routing pipeline built from several prompts.

Engineers want the prompts and few-shot examples tuned automatically against the metric, not by hand.

Which framework is built for this?

A LangChain, for composing the pipeline steps

B LlamaIndex, for loading and indexing documents

C The OpenAI Agents SDK, for agents and handoffs

D DSPy, which optimises prompts against a metric

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which framework is built for this?

A LangChain, for composing the pipeline steps
Composes steps; prompts are still hand-written.

B LlamaIndex, for loading and indexing documents
Specialises in ingestion and indexing.

C The OpenAI Agents SDK, for agents and handoffs
Builds agents; no prompt optimisation.

D DSPy, which optimises prompts against a metric
Exactly its purpose.

THE SIGNAL

Labelled examples, a metric, and automatic prompt tuning. That is DSPy's defining purpose.

> A chunk table stores one row per document, with its chunks in an array column. A nightly job rebuilds it, giving every chunk a new random ID.
>
> The index returns whole documents, and duplicates pile up. Choose TWO.

Which two changes fix these problems?

A Flatten to one row per chunk, using posexplode

B Build each chunk ID from the document ID and position

C Move to a larger embedding model with more dimensions

D Switch the index from triggered to continuous sync

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

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Which two changes fix these problems?

A Flatten to one row per chunk, using posexplode

One row per chunk gives one vector per chunk.

B Build each chunk ID from the document ID and position

Stable IDs let MERGE update rather than duplicate.

C Move to a larger embedding model with more dimensions

Still one vector per document.

D Switch the index from triggered to continuous sync

Syncs the duplicates faster.

THE SIGNAL

Whole documents come back, and duplicates grow. One fix for each: flatten, and stable IDs.

> An agent on Model Serving calls a Genie space. It was logged with a DatabricksGenieSpace resource and nothing else.
>
> Requests fail whenever Genie tries to run its generated SQL.

What is the most likely fix?

A Also declare the space's tables and SQL warehouse as resources

B Switch the agent to manual auth using a personal access token

C Grant all end users CAN MANAGE on the Genie space itself

D Recreate the Genie space inside the agent's own schema

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most likely fix?

A Also declare the space's tables and SQL warehouse as resources

Downstream resources must be declared too.

B Switch the agent to manual auth using a personal access token

Swaps managed credentials for a long-lived token.

C Grant all end users CAN MANAGE on the Genie space itself

Automatic passthrough does not use users' permissions.

D Recreate the Genie space inside the agent's own schema

Moving it does not declare its dependencies.

THE SIGNAL

The space is declared, but its SQL fails. Genie's tables and warehouse were never declared.

> An engineer runs a LangChain agent in a notebook on serverless compute. Nothing appears in the MLflow experiment's traces.
>
> The same code produced traces on classic compute last month.

What is the most likely fix?

A Rewrite the agent in LangGraph, which traces itself

B Call mlflow.langchain.autolog() before running the agent

C Raise the Python logging level to DEBUG for the session

D Move the agent to a larger model endpoint and retry it

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most likely fix?

A Rewrite the agent in LangGraph, which traces itself

Same requirement applies to LangGraph on serverless.

B Call mlflow.langchain.autolog() before running the agent

On serverless, autologging must be switched on explicitly.

C Raise the Python logging level to DEBUG for the session

MLflow traces are not Python log messages.

D Move the agent to a larger model endpoint and retry it

Model choice has nothing to do with tracing.

THE SIGNAL

Serverless, and no traces. GenAI autologging is not switched on automatically there.

> A garden centre's prices and stock change every week. The team proposes fine-tuning a model on the current price list so its assistant can answer price questions.
>
> Prices are held in a table keyed by product code.

What should the engineer recommend instead?

A Fine-tune weekly, so the model keeps up with each change

B Put the whole price list into the system prompt each day

C Look up prices by product code from the table when asked

D Train a larger model on two years of historical prices

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the engineer recommend instead?

A Fine-tune weekly, so the model keeps up with each change

A retrain per change, and still lagging.

B Put the whole price list into the system prompt each day

Bloated prompt, and stale within the day.

C Look up prices by product code from the table when asked

Exact, current values, fetched when needed.

D Train a larger model on two years of historical prices

History does not tell this week's price.

THE SIGNAL

Values that change weekly, in a table keyed by code. That is a keyed lookup, not fine-tuning.

> Before a release, policy experts must write the expected facts for 200 questions. Before that, they want to try the new version informally to get a feel for it.
>
> Choose TWO.

Which two Review App features fit?

A. A thumbs-up button in the production app

B. The chat UI, for informal vibe checks first

C. A numeric 1 to 5 feedback scale on traces

D. A labelling session with an expectation schema

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two Review App features fit?

A A thumbs-up button in the production app

End-user feedback, not expert work before release.

B The chat UI, for informal vibe checks first

Built for informal testing before a release.

C A numeric 1 to 5 feedback scale on traces

Feedback ratings, not expected facts.

D A labelling session with an expectation schema

Captures ground truth for Correctness.

THE SIGNAL

Informal first, then ground truth. The chat UI, then an expectation schema.

A Databricks App lets managers ask Genie questions and run SQL on their behalf. It uses user authorisation.

Security wants the app limited to exactly what it needs.

How should the scopes be configured?

A Request every available scope, in case they are needed later

B Request no scopes, and use the app's service principal instead

C Request only the model-serving scope for every call it makes

D Request only the genie and sql scopes that the app actually uses

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the scopes be configured?

A Request every available scope, in case they are needed later

The opposite of least privilege.

B Request no scopes, and use the app's service principal instead

Loses per-user access, which user auth provides.

C Request only the model-serving scope for every call it makes

Wrong scope: the app calls Genie and SQL.

D Request only the genie and sql scopes that the app actually uses

Least privilege: just what it uses.

THE SIGNAL

Limited to exactly what it needs. Request only the scopes the app actually uses.

> An agent must run with different serving endpoints, prompts and retrieval depths in development and production.
>
> Today these are hard-coded, so each change needs a code edit and a fresh review.

What should the engineer use?

A MLflow ModelConfig, reading the values from a YAML file

B Separate copies of the agent code for each environment

C If statements in the code that test for the environment

D User messages that carry the settings at request time

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the engineer use?

A MLflow ModelConfig, reading the values from a YAML file

Same code, different config, logged with the model.

B Separate copies of the agent code for each environment

Two codebases that will drift apart.

C If statements in the code that test for the environment

Still hard-coded, just scattered.

D User messages that carry the settings at request time

Users could change prompts and endpoints.

THE SIGNAL

Same agent, different values per environment, no code edits. That is ModelConfig.

> An analytics agent writes Python and runs it to answer questions about uploaded spreadsheets. Uploaded files come from outside the company.
>
> Security asks which DASF control applies to the generated code.

What should the team do?

A. Run the generated code on the main ETL cluster, for extra speed

B. Have the model confirm that its own code is safe first

C. Run the code in a sandbox, with least privilege and no secrets

D. Give the agent an admin token, so that its code rarely fails

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do?

A Run the generated code on the main ETL cluster, for extra speed

Opens a path to production data and jobs.

B Have the model confirm that its own code is safe first

A possibly fooled model marks its own homework.

C Run the code in a sandbox, with least privilege and no secrets

DASF 3.0's control for agent-generated code.

D Give the agent an admin token, so that its code rarely fails

The opposite of least privilege.

THE SIGNAL

Code shaped by untrusted files is untrusted code. DASF 3.0 names sandboxing for it.

> A regulator's rulebook is published each year, and every edition is in the index. Questions often name a year, such as what applied in 2022.
>
> Answers frequently quote a different year's edition.

What should the engineer do?

A Enable the reranker, so the right edition ranks first

B Tag each chunk with its edition year, and filter on it

C Use much larger chunks, so each holds more of an edition

D Increase the overlap, so editions blend less at the edges

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the engineer do?

A Enable the reranker, so the right edition ranks first

Every edition is equally relevant to the question.

B Tag each chunk with its edition year, and filter on it

Only metadata can tell near-identical editions apart.

C Use much larger chunks, so each holds more of an edition

Blurs vectors; the year is still not matched.

D Increase the overlap, so editions blend less at the edges

Affects edges, not which edition is chosen.

THE SIGNAL

Near-identical editions, and a year in the question. Only metadata separates them.

> An app uses the Genie Conversation API. To save effort, it sends every user's questions through one long-running conversation.
>
> Over time, answers mix up context from different users.

What should the developer change?

A Start a new conversation for each user session

B Poll for the answer twice as often as it does now

C Add every table in the catalog to the Genie space

D Switch the Genie space to agent mode for all users

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the developer change?

A Start a new conversation for each user session
Each session gets its own context. Databricks' advice.

B Poll for the answer twice as often as it does now
Timing does not separate contexts.

C Add every table in the catalog to the Genie space
More confusion, not less.

D Switch the Genie space to agent mode for all users
Still one shared thread.

THE SIGNAL

One thread for everyone, and mixed-up context. A conversation carries context, so each session needs its own.

A team switches its self-managed AI Search index from BGE to GTE embeddings, to handle longer chunks.

Choose TWO.

Which two steps are required?

A Keep the existing BGE vectors for the older chunks

B Raise num_results to make up for any quality loss

C Re-embed every chunk in the index using GTE

D Embed every query with GTE, the same model

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two steps are required?

A Keep the existing BGE vectors for the older chunks

Mixing models breaks similarity entirely.

B Raise num_results to make up for any quality loss

More results cannot fix incomparable vectors.

C Re-embed every chunk in the index using GTE

Changing model means re-embedding everything.

D Embed every query with GTE, the same model

Queries must use the same model as documents.

THE SIGNAL

New embedding model: every chunk re-embedded, and every query too. One model, one space.

> A travel company's assistant must follow two rules. Never quote a price that is not in the retrieved fare table. Always mention the cancellation policy for bookings.
>
> The team wants every response checked against these rules, in evaluation and in production.

Which judge fits best?

A Correctness, with each rule written as an expected fact

B Safety, since breaking the rules could harm customers

C RetrievalRelevance, so the rules are retrieved each time

D Guidelines, with each rule written as a plain guideline

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which judge fits best?

A Correctness, with each rule written as an expected fact

Checks facts in answers, not behaviour rules.

B Safety, since breaking the rules could harm customers

Checks harmful content, not business rules.

C RetrievalRelevance, so the rules are retrieved each time

Scores retrieved chunks, not the response.

D Guidelines, with each rule written as a plain guideline

Checks written rules, and needs no ground truth.

THE SIGNAL

Business rules in plain language, in evaluation and production. Guidelines needs no mark scheme.

A pension provider's assistant gives accurate answers, but they are long and full of jargon. Members want short, plain-English replies.

Choose TWO.

Which two changes best shift the responses?

A Use an embedding model with more dimensions for retrieval

B State the audience, reading level and maximum length

C Add two or three example answers in plain English

D Move to a model with a much larger context window

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two changes best shift the responses?

A Use an embedding model with more dimensions for retrieval

Changes retrieval, not how answers are written.

B State the audience, reading level and maximum length

A positive, measurable target for style.

C Add two or three example answers in plain English

Examples shift style fastest.

D Move to a model with a much larger context window

More room, same voice.

THE SIGNAL

Accurate but wrong style. Style techniques work; retrieval and capacity settings do not.

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A script from one internal user is sending thousands of long requests a minute to a shared assistant endpoint.

Costs are spiking, and other users are seeing slow replies.

What is the most direct control?

A. A jailbreak guardrail on the endpoint's input phase

B. Per-user rate limits on the endpoint in the gateway

C. A monthly budget alert on model serving spending

D. Provisioned throughput, to absorb the extra load

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most direct control?

A. A jailbreak guardrail on the endpoint's input phase
The requests may be harmless. Volume is the problem.

B. Per-user rate limits on the endpoint in the gateway
Caps that user immediately; others unaffected.

C. A monthly budget alert on model serving spending
Tells finance later. Stops nothing.

D. Provisioned throughput, to absorb the extra load
Buys more capacity for the script to consume.

THE SIGNAL

One user flooding a shared endpoint. A per-user rate limit contains exactly that, immediately.

> An IT helpdesk receives three kinds of request: password resets, laptop orders and VPN questions. Each is fully handled by one existing component.
>
> Answers must come back in under two seconds, and each path must be testable on its own.

Which design fits best?

A An autonomous agent with every component as a tool

B A multi-agent supervisor coordinating three specialists

C A classifier that routes each request to its one handler

D A single retrieval chain over all the helpdesk data

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which design fits best?

A An autonomous agent with every component as a tool

Pays for reasoning loops nothing needs.

B A multi-agent supervisor coordinating three specialists

Most machinery for the simplest flow.

C A classifier that routes each request to its one handler

Decides once, fast, and each route is testable.

D A single retrieval chain over all the helpdesk data

Resets and orders are actions, not passages.

THE SIGNAL

Each type fully handled by one component. When one handler completes each request, route.

Where did your misses fall?

SECTION	QUESTIONS	REWATCH MODULES
Design (section 1)	7, 14, 25	01 to 05
Data (section 2)	4, 11, 19	06 to 10
Develop (section 3)	1, 6, 10, 13, 17, 20, 21, 23	11 to 20
Deploy (section 4)	2, 8, 12, 16	21 to 28
Govern (section 5)	5, 18, 24	29 and 30
Evaluate (section 6)	3, 9, 15, 22	31 to 34

ON THE EXAM

Count misses per section. Two or more in one section tells you where to spend your next study session.

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What three papers tell you

- Put your misses per section from all **three papers** side by side.
- A section missed in **every** paper is a real gap. Rewatch its modules now.
- A section improving across papers is working. Leave it alone.
- Ready: around **20 of 25** on two papers, and no section missed every time.
- Last days: modules 35 to 37, and the pair tables in module 36.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The trend matters more than any single score. Spend your final hours on the section that kept costing you marks.

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